HEALTHCARE HEROES

SPOTLIGHT









Saluting a noble profession

The Times of India and Maharashtra Times hosted the first-ever Medical Excellence Recognition Program for the medical fraternity of Government Medical College and Hospital, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar. The initiative celebrated the dedication, expertise and contribution of doctors and healthcare professionals serving the region

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In a first-of-its-kind initiative, The Times of India and Maharashtra Times brought together the distinguished medical fraternity of Government Medical College and Hospital (GMCH), Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, for an evening celebrating clinical excellence, academic achievement and dedicated service. The programme recognised the invaluable contribution of GMCH's doctors and faculty members towards patient care, medical education and research.

HEALING HANDS

The ceremony was attended by Dr Pallavi Supriya Prabhakar Saple, director, Directorate of Medical Education and Research (DMER), Maharashtra, as chief guest, while Dr Shivaji Sukre, dean, Government Medical College and Hospital, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, was the guest of honour. Senior faculty members, department heads, medical professionals, academicians, alumni and dignitaries from the GMCH fraternity were also present.

A key highlight of the evening was the presentation of citations to distinguished doctors and faculty members from various departments of GMCH for their contributions to clinical services, teaching, research, innovation, public health and institutional development. The programme celebrated years of dedicated service and acknowledged the role these professionals play in strengthening healthcare delivery across the region.

Addressing the gathering, Dr Pallavi Saple, director, Directorate of Medical Education and Research (DMER), Maharashtra, said, "I had the opportunity to serve patients in Ambajogai, Marathwada, for three years and have also worked in different parts of the state. Having seen the healthcare landscape closely, I can say that Government Medical College and Hospital has become a vital healthcare institution for the Marathwada region. Today, I visited the Government Medical College and the Cancer Hospital, and the work being carried out here is undoubtedly significant. Through the services offered at GMCH, the Cancer Hospital and other government medical institutions across Maharashtra, poor and needy patients are directly benefiting from various healthcare schemes."

Appreciating the initiative, she added, "The recognition programme organised by The Times of India and Maharashtra Times is truly inspiring. Doctors often set aside their personal lives and important family moments to serve patients. I have personally witnessed the dedication of doctors, nurses and the entire medical staff. Such initiatives acknowledge that commitment and encourage medical professionals to continue striving for excellence. We have also submitted a proposal to organise a state-level recognition programme for doctor-professors who are shaping future generations through medical education, and this will certainly be considered."

QUALITY MEDICAL EDUCATION

Calling the initiative a proud moment for the institution, Dr Shivaji Sukre, dean, Government Medical College and Hospital, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, said, "The recognition extended by The Times of India and Maharashtra Times to the doctors of GMCH is a matter of immense pride for me and my entire medical team. Providing quality patient care while imparting medical education is our responsibility, but such appreciation from respected newspapers energises our doctors, nurses and medical staff to serve society with even greater dedication."

Speaking about the institution's recent initiatives, he said, "Today, Dr Pallavi Saple visited the Government Medical College, the Super Specialty Hospital and the Cancer Hospital. The Super Specialty Hospital has earned recognition across Maharashtra for its contribution to patient care. We have also made the hospital prescription-slip free to ensure greater transparency and eliminate inconvenience for patients."

Referring to patient care, he added, "The state government has allocated substantial funds to GMCH in this year's supplementary budget. We are making every effort to ensure that every eligible patient benefits from the Pradhan Mantri Arogya Yojana and other government healthcare schemes. Patients from rural areas and neighbouring districts visit GMCH every day, placing tremendous pressure on our doctors, nurses and support staff. Yet, through teamwork and unwavering commitment, our entire medical fraternity continues to deliver the best possible care."

MAKING A POSITIVE DIFFERENCE

Welcoming the initiative, Dr Arvind Gaikwad of the Cancer Hospital said, "A doctor remains on call 24 hours a day. There are countless occasions when we have to set aside our personal lives, family events and celebrations because a patient needs us. When the media acknowledges good work, it sends out a powerful message that society values sincerity and dedication."

Referring to the institution's growth, he added, "Our Cancer Hospital is steadily emerging as one of the state's leading centres for cancer care. No institution can claim to be perfect, but our entire team is constantly working towards improving patient care and strengthening the services we provide. I sincerely thank The Times of India and Maharashtra Times for this thoughtful initiative."

The event also provided an opportunity for senior healthcare leaders, academicians and medical practitioners to interact and exchange ideas on the future of medical education, collaborative research and patient-centric healthcare.

HAILING THE HEALERS

- Dr Amol Joshi
- Dr Anita Kandi
- Dr Archana Patil Vare
- Dr Arvind Gaikwad
- Dr Bharat Sonwane
- Dr Darpan Pandharinath Jakkal
- Dr Gayatri Vivek Tadwalkar
- Dr Maruti Lingayat
- Dr Meenakshi Bhattacharya
- Dr Mirza S Baig
- Dr Pallavi Rameshrao Chavan
- Dr Prabha More Khaire
- Dr Shital Dikle Patil
- Dr Shailesh Bhaginath Nikam
- Dr Shilpa Balaji Asegaonkar
- Dr Shivaji Sukre
- Dr Smita Padmakarrao Andurkar
- Dr Sonali Deshpande
- Dr Suchita Annasaheb Joshi
- Dr Vajed Mogal
- Dr Varsha Rote







Dr Shivaji Sukre





Dr Mirza S Baig



Dr Anita Kandi



Dr Maruti Lingayat



Dr Arvind Gaikwad



Dr Prabhakar Jirvankar



Dr Varsha Rote



Dr Darpan Pandharinath Jakkal



Dr Vajed Mogal



Dr Ajay Vare



Dr Meenakshi Bhattacharya



Dr Amol Joshi



Dr Pallavi Rameshrao Chavan



Dr Prabha More Khaire



Dr Bharat Sonwane



Dr Shital Dikle Patil



Dr Shailesh Bhaginath Nikam



Dr Shilpa Balaji Asegaonkar



Dr Sonali Deshpande



Dr Gayatri Vivek Tadwalkar